



RED BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident:	14 September 2023	Time of Incident:	15:00
Directorate / Region:	Great Southern Region	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury/Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	33927
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Vegetation removal without traffic management
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What Happened:

A work team of three in a routine maintenance truck were assigned a vegetation removal (fallen tree) fault report on South West Highway SLK 416.

The work team responded to the report and observed a branch had fallen, blocking approximately half of an eastbound lane on double white lines in a 90km/h area. No traffic management was set up prior to the vegetation removal task commencing.

The truck parked approximately 40 meters from the branch with the vehicle covering approximately two thirds of the lane. The Supervisor then drove through the area on his way to another destination and assisted by parking on the westbound shoulder, spotting vehicles heading toward the workers. The Supervisor used his vehicle flashing lights and flashing headlights to warn oncoming motorists.

As the work crew were undertaking the task on the road using a chainsaw, a motorist drove around the truck and came head on with another motorist (truck) causing them both to slow down to avoid the workers on the road. The workers on the road were not aware of the near miss and kept working.

A Supervisor and HSEQ worker drove through site and observed the traffic management improvements required and later viewed the dash cam footage.

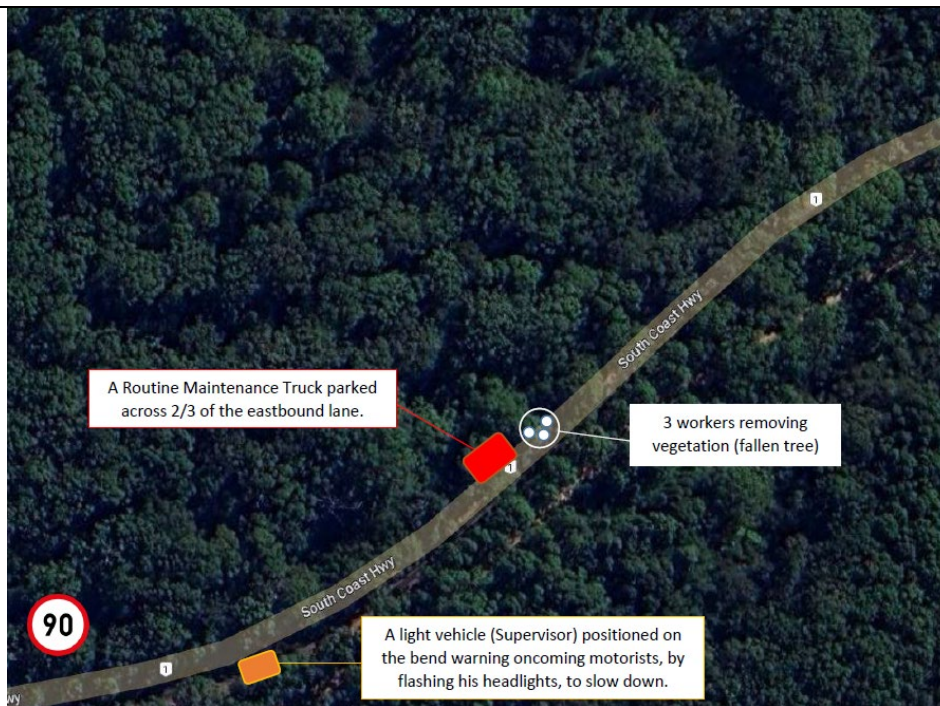


Image 1: Worker position setup details

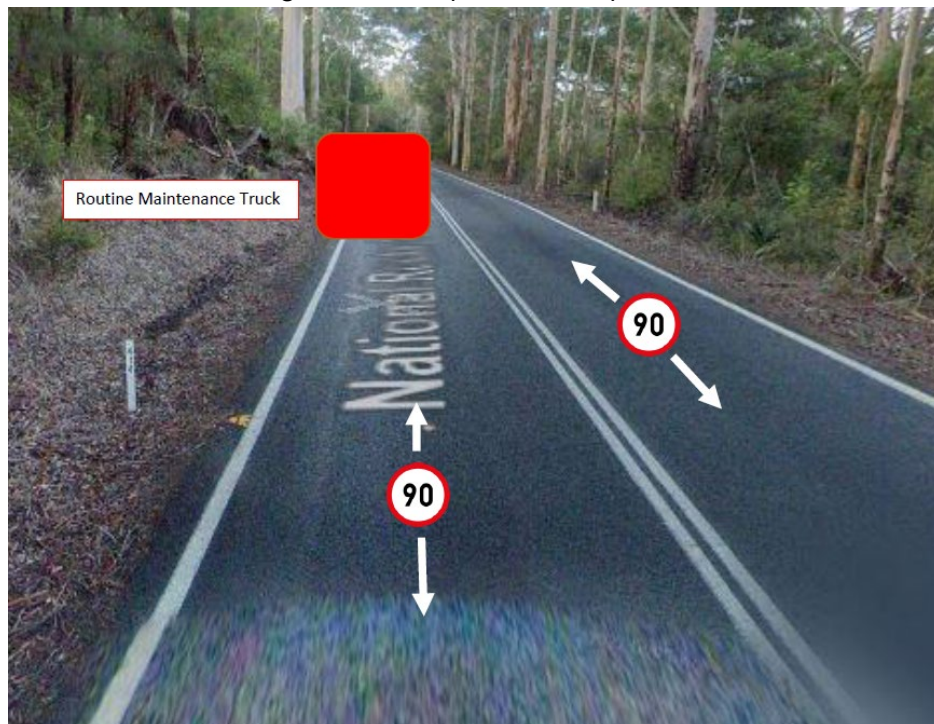


Image 2: Location on road

A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to **Interaction with Live Traffic**.

Immediate Actions:

Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):

- *All personnel must ensure they remain out of the line of fire of live traffic.*
- *All personnel must understand and follow the controls relevant to their scope of work as per the Traffic Management Plan (TMP) and agreed Traffic Guidance Scheme (TGS) when working adjacent to live traffic.*
- *Ensure workers understand traffic management risk and control requirements for their operations and these are identified and addressed in risk assessments.*

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations